

Introducing IDLE

IDLE helps you write and run programs in Python. See how it works by creating this simple program that writes a message on the screen.

SEE ALSO

◀ **88–91** Installing Python

Which **106–107** ▶
window?

Working in IDLE

Follow these steps to make a Python program using IDLE. It will teach you how to enter, save, and run programs.

1 Start IDLE

Start up IDLE using the instructions for your computer's operating system (see pp.88–91). The shell window opens. This window shows the program output (any information the program produces) and any errors.



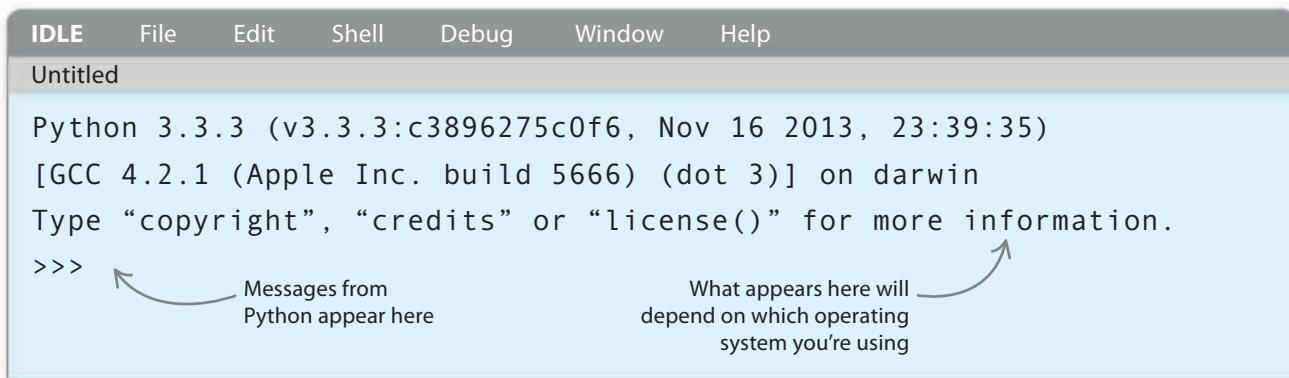
EXPERT TIPS

Different windows

Python uses two different windows—the “shell” window and the “code” window (see pages 106–107). We’ve given them different colors to tell them apart.

Shell window

Code window



2 Open a new window

Click the “File” menu at the top of the shell window and select “New Window”. This opens the code window.

